

Inner Product Spaces

Chapter 1c: Pathak's Introduction to Nonlinear Analysis

Based on H.K. Pathak (2018)

2026

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Inner Product

Definition (Inner Product)

Let X be a complex linear space. A function $\langle \cdot, \cdot \rangle : X \times X \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$ is called an *inner product* if for all $x, y, z \in X$ and $\lambda \in \mathbb{C}$:

IP1 $\langle x, x \rangle \geq 0$ (positivity)

IP2 $\langle x, x \rangle = 0 \iff x = 0$ (definiteness)

IP3 $\langle x, y \rangle = \overline{\langle y, x \rangle}$ (conjugate symmetry)

IP4 $\langle \lambda x + y, z \rangle = \lambda \langle x, z \rangle + \langle y, z \rangle$ (linearity in first argument)

An *inner product space* is a linear space with an inner product.

Consequences of the definition:

- $\langle x, y + z \rangle = \langle x, y \rangle + \langle x, z \rangle$
- $\langle x, \lambda y \rangle = \bar{\lambda} \langle x, y \rangle$

Induced Norm and Cauchy-Schwarz

Theorem (Norm Induced by Inner Product)

For any inner product space, the function $\| \cdot \| : X \rightarrow \mathbb{R}_+$ defined by

$$\|x\| = \sqrt{\langle x, x \rangle}$$

is a norm on X . This is called the Hilbertian norm.

Theorem (Cauchy-Schwarz Inequality)

For all $x, y \in X$,

$$|\langle x, y \rangle| \leq \|x\| \cdot \|y\|$$

with equality if and only if x and y are linearly dependent.

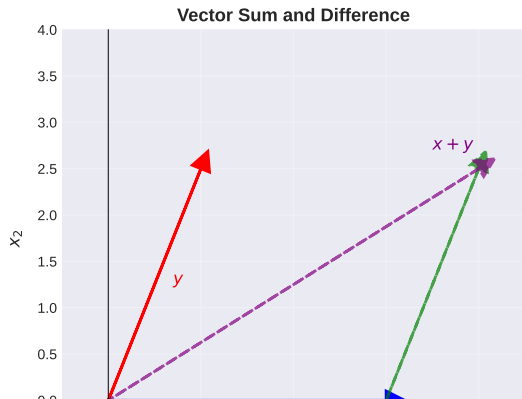
Cauchy-Schwarz Inequality

Parallelogram Law

Theorem (Parallelogram Law)

For all x, y in an inner product space:

$$2(\|x\|^2 + \|y\|^2) = \|x + y\|^2 + \|x - y\|^2$$



Parallelogram Law

$$2(\|x\|^2 + \|y\|^2) = \|x + y\|^2 + \|x - y\|^2$$

*This law characterizes inner product spaces.
A normed space is an inner product space
if and only if the parallelogram law holds.*

Orthogonality

Definition (Orthogonal Vectors)

Two vectors x, y in an inner product space are *orthogonal*, denoted $x \perp y$, if

$$\langle x, y \rangle = 0$$

Theorem (Pythagorean Theorem)

If $x \perp y$, then

$$\|x + y\|^2 = \|x\|^2 + \|y\|^2$$

Definition (Orthonormal Set)

A set $\{e_i\}_{i \in I}$ is *orthonormal* if:

- $\langle e_i, e_j \rangle = \delta_{ij}$ (Kronecker delta) for all $i, j \in I$
- $\delta_{ij} = 1$ if $i = j$, and $\delta_{ij} = 0$ if $i \neq j$

Definition of Hilbert Space

Definition (Hilbert Space)

A Hilbert space H is a complete inner product space. That is:

- H is an inner product space with inner product $\langle \cdot, \cdot \rangle$
- H is complete with respect to the norm $\|x\| = \sqrt{\langle x, x \rangle}$
- Every Cauchy sequence in H converges to a point in H

In other words, a Hilbert space is a complete Banach space with an inner product structure.

Remark:

- Every Hilbert space is a Banach space
- Not every Banach space is a Hilbert space (e.g., ℓ^p with $p \neq 2$)
- Hilbert spaces have the special feature of being self-dual

Common Hilbert Spaces

Examples of Hilbert Spaces

Example 1: Finite Dimensional

$$\mathbb{R}^n = \{(x_1, \dots, x_n) : x_i \in \mathbb{R}\}$$

with $\langle x, y \rangle = \sum_{i=1}^n x_i y_i$, $\|x\|_2 = \sqrt{\sum_{i=1}^n x_i^2}$.

Example 2: ℓ^2 Space

$$\ell^2 = \left\{ (x_i)_{i=1}^{\infty} : \sum_{i=1}^{\infty} |x_i|^2 < \infty \right\}$$

with $\langle x, y \rangle = \sum_{i=1}^{\infty} x_i \overline{y_i}$ and $\|x\|_2 = \sqrt{\sum_{i=1}^{\infty} |x_i|^2}$.

Example 3: $L^2[a, b]$ Space

$$L^2[a, b] = \left\{ f : [a, b] \rightarrow \mathbb{C} : \int_a^b |f(t)|^2 dt < \infty \right\}$$

with $\langle f, g \rangle = \int_a^b f(t) \overline{g(t)} dt$ and $\|f\| = \sqrt{\int_a^b |f(t)|^2 dt}$.

Example 4: Weighted L^2 Space

Numerical Example: The ℓ^2 Space

```
import numpy as np

# Example: Geometric series sequence
x = np.array([1/2**i for i in range(1, 20)])
y = np.array([1/3**i for i in range(1, 20)])

# Inner product
inner_prod = np.sum(x * y)
print(f"<x, y> = {inner_prod:.6f}")

# Norms
norm_x = np.linalg.norm(x)
norm_y = np.linalg.norm(y)
print(f"||x|| = {norm_x:.6f}")
print(f"||y|| = {norm_y:.6f}")

# Cauchy-Schwarz check
cs_lhs = abs(inner_prod)
cs_rhs = norm_x * norm_y
print(f"|<x,y>| = {cs_lhs:.6f} <= {cs_rhs:.6f}")
print(f"Inequality satisfied: {cs_lhs <= cs_rhs}")

# Pythagorean theorem: Check orthogonality
z = np.array([(-1)**i / 4**i for i in range(1, 20)])
inner_xz = np.sum(x * z)
norm_x_plus_z = np.linalg.norm(x + z)
norm_x_sq_plus_norm_z_sq = norm_x**2 + np.linalg.norm(z)**2
```

Orthogonal Projection onto Subspaces

Theorem (Orthogonal Projection)

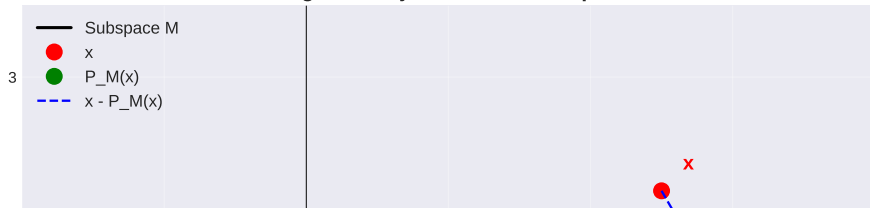
Let M be a closed convex subset of a Hilbert space H . For each $x \in H$, there exists a unique point $P_M(x) \in M$ (the projection of x onto M) such that

$$\|x - P_M(x)\| = \min_{y \in M} \|x - y\|$$

Moreover, $P_M(x)$ is characterized by:

$$\langle x - P_M(x), y - P_M(x) \rangle \leq 0 \quad \text{for all } y \in M$$

Orthogonal Projection onto Subspace M



Orthogonal Projection - Algebraic Properties

Theorem (Projection Operator Properties)

If M is a closed linear subspace of H , then:

- $P_M : H \rightarrow M$ is a linear operator
- $P_M^2 = P_M$ (idempotence): $P_M(P_M(x)) = P_M(x)$
- $\|P_M(x)\| \leq \|x\|$ for all $x \in H$ (contractivity)
- $H = M \oplus M^\perp$ (orthogonal decomposition)
- $P_{M^\perp} = I - P_M$ (complementary projection)

Definition (Orthogonal Complement)

The orthogonal complement of M is

$$M^\perp = \{x \in H : \langle x, y \rangle = 0 \text{ for all } y \in M\}$$

Application: Every vector $x \in H$ can be uniquely written as

$$x = P_M(x) + P_{M^\perp}(x)$$

Gram-Schmidt Orthogonalization Process

Theorem (Gram-Schmidt Process)

Let $\{v_1, v_2, v_3, \dots\}$ be a linearly independent sequence in an inner product space. Then there exists an orthonormal sequence $\{e_1, e_2, e_3, \dots\}$ such that for each n , the span of $\{e_1, \dots, e_n\}$ equals the span of $\{v_1, \dots, v_n\}$.

Procedure:

Gram-Schmidt Orthogonalization Process

$$e_1 = \frac{v_1}{\|v_1\|}$$

Normalize first vector

$$u_2 = v_2 - \langle v_2, e_1 \rangle e_1$$

Orthogonalize second vector

Complete Orthonormal Systems

Definition (Complete Orthonormal System)

A set $\{e_i\}_{i \in I}$ is a *complete orthonormal system* (CONS) if:

- It is orthonormal: $\langle e_i, e_j \rangle = \delta_{ij}$
- It is complete: if $\langle x, e_i \rangle = 0$ for all $i \in I$, then $x = 0$

Complete Orthonormal System (CONS) in Hilbert Space

An orthonormal set $\{e_i\}_{i \in I}$ is complete if:

$$\langle x, e_i \rangle = 0 \text{ for all } i \Rightarrow x = 0$$

Parseval's Equality: $\|x\|^2 = \sum_{i \in I} |\langle x, e_i \rangle|^2$

Parseval's Equality

Theorem (Parseval's Equality)

Let $\{e_i\}_{i=1}^{\infty}$ be a complete orthonormal system in a Hilbert space H . Then for all $x \in H$:

$$\|x\|^2 = \sum_{i=1}^{\infty} |\langle x, e_i \rangle|^2$$

Consequence: The Fourier coefficients $c_i = \langle x, e_i \rangle$ form an ℓ^2 sequence.

Example (Trigonometric Basis in $L^2[0, 2\pi]$)

The orthonormal system $\left\{ \frac{1}{\sqrt{2\pi}}, \frac{\cos(nx)}{\sqrt{\pi}}, \frac{\sin(nx)}{\sqrt{\pi}} : n \in \mathbb{N} \right\}$ is complete in $L^2[0, 2\pi]$, yielding the classical Fourier series.

For $f \in L^2[0, 2\pi]$:

$$\int_0^{2\pi} |f(x)|^2 dx = 2\pi a_0^2 + \pi \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} (a_n^2 + b_n^2)$$

Riesz Representation Theorem

Theorem (Riesz Representation Theorem)

Let H be a Hilbert space and $f : H \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$ a bounded linear functional. Then there exists a unique $y \in H$ such that

$$f(x) = \langle x, y \rangle \quad \text{for all } x \in H$$

Moreover, $\|f\| = \|y\|$.

Riesz Representation Theorem

For any bounded linear functional f on a Hilbert space H , there exists a unique $y \in H$ such that

$$f(x) = \langle x, y \rangle \text{ for all } x \in H$$

Application: Linear Equations in Hilbert Spaces

Theorem (Lax-Milgram Theorem)

Let $a : H \times H \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$ be a bounded bilinear form satisfying:

- *Boundedness:* $|a(x, y)| \leq M\|x\|\|y\|$ for some $M > 0$
- *Coercivity:* $|a(x, x)| \geq m\|x\|^2$ for some $m > 0$

Then for each bounded linear functional $f : H \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$, there exists a unique $u \in H$ such that

$$a(u, v) = f(v) \quad \text{for all } v \in H$$

Significance:

- Ensures solvability of abstract variational problems
- Applies to weak formulations of PDEs
- Fundamental for numerical methods (finite element methods)

Modes of Convergence

Convergence Concepts in Hilbert Spaces

Strong Convergence

$$\|x_n - x\| \rightarrow 0$$

Norm convergence

Weak Convergence

$$\langle x_n, y \rangle \rightarrow \langle x, y \rangle \text{ for all } y \in H$$

Weaker notion

Properties of Weak Convergence

Theorem (Properties of Weakly Convergent Sequences)

If $x_n \rightharpoonup x$ in H , then:

- The sequence $\{\|x_n\|\}$ is bounded
- $\|x\| \leq \liminf_{n \rightarrow \infty} \|x_n\|$ (lower semicontinuity of norm)
- The limit x is unique
- If $x_n \rightarrow x$ strongly, then $x_n \rightharpoonup x$ (strong implies weak)

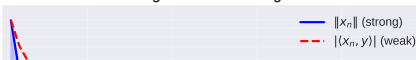
Example (Weak Convergence Without Strong Convergence)

In ℓ^2 , let e_n be the n -th standard basis vector. Then:

- $e_n \rightharpoonup 0$ (weak convergence)
- $\|e_n - 0\| = 1$ for all n (no strong convergence)

Strong vs Weak Convergence

10^0



Compactness in Hilbert Spaces

Theorem (Eberlein-Smulian Theorem)

A subset C of a Hilbert space H is weakly compact if and only if it is weakly sequentially compact. That is, every sequence in C has a weakly convergent subsequence.

Theorem (Weak Compactness of Closed Balls)

In an infinite-dimensional Hilbert space:

- *Closed balls are weakly compact but NOT compact (in the strong topology)*
- *Every bounded sequence has a weakly convergent subsequence*
- *This is the basis for many existence results in analysis*

Consequence: Variational problems in Hilbert spaces often have solutions because:

- 1 Minimizing sequences are bounded
- 2 Bounded sequences have weakly convergent subsequences
- 3 Many functionals are weakly lower semicontinuous

Linear Operators in Hilbert Spaces

Definition (Bounded Linear Operator)

A linear operator $A : H_1 \rightarrow H_2$ between Hilbert spaces is *bounded* if

$$\|A\| = \sup_{\|x\|=1} \|Ax\| < \infty$$

Definition (Adjoint Operator)

For a bounded linear operator $A : H \rightarrow H$, the *adjoint* $A^* : H \rightarrow H$ is defined by

$$\langle Ax, y \rangle = \langle x, A^*y \rangle \quad \text{for all } x, y \in H$$

Properties of the adjoint:

- $(A^*)^* = A$ (involution)
- $(A + B)^* = A^* + B^*$
- $(\lambda A)^* = \bar{\lambda} A^*$
- $(AB)^* = B^* A^*$ (reverse order)
- $\|A^*\| = \|A\|$

Special Classes of Operators

Definition (Self-Adjoint Operator)

An operator A is *self-adjoint* if $A = A^*$, i.e.,

$$\langle Ax, y \rangle = \langle x, Ay \rangle \quad \text{for all } x, y \in H$$

Definition (Unitary Operator)

An operator U is *unitary* if $U^*U = UU^* = I$ (isometry and surjective).

Definition (Normal Operator)

An operator A is *normal* if $A^*A = AA^*$.

Definition (Compact Operator)

An operator A is *compact* if it maps bounded sets to relatively compact sets.

Spectral decomposition: Compact self-adjoint operators have countable spectrum with eigenvectors forming a complete orthonormal basis

Numerical Example: Operators in ℓ^2

```
import numpy as np

# Define an orthonormal basis in  $\mathbb{R}^5$  approximating  $\ell^2$ 
n = 100
e = np.eye(n) # Standard basis

# Define a self-adjoint operator: diagonal matrix
lamda = np.array([1 - i/n for i in range(n)])
A = np.diag(lamda)

# Test:  $\langle Ax, y \rangle = \langle x, A^*y \rangle = \langle x, Ay \rangle$ 
x = np.ones(n) / np.sqrt(n)
y = np.zeros(n)
y[:10] = 1/np.sqrt(10)

lhs = np.dot(A @ x, y)
rhs = np.dot(x, A @ y)
print(f"<Ax, y> = {lhs:.6f}")
print(f"<x, Ay> = {rhs:.6f}")
print(f"Self-adjoint test passed: {np.isclose(lhs, rhs)}")

# Compute eigenvalues
eigenvalues = np.diag(A)
print(f"\nEigenvalues (first 10): {eigenvalues[:10]}")
print(f"Operator norm ||A|| = {np.max(np.abs(eigenvalues)):.6f}")

# Check spectrum property
```

Applications of Hilbert Space Theory

Applications of Hilbert Space Theory

Quantum Mechanics

State space as Hilbert space (wave functions)

Signal Processing

Fourier analysis, wavelets, time-frequency analysis

Partial Differential Equations

Weak solutions, Sobolev spaces

Optimization

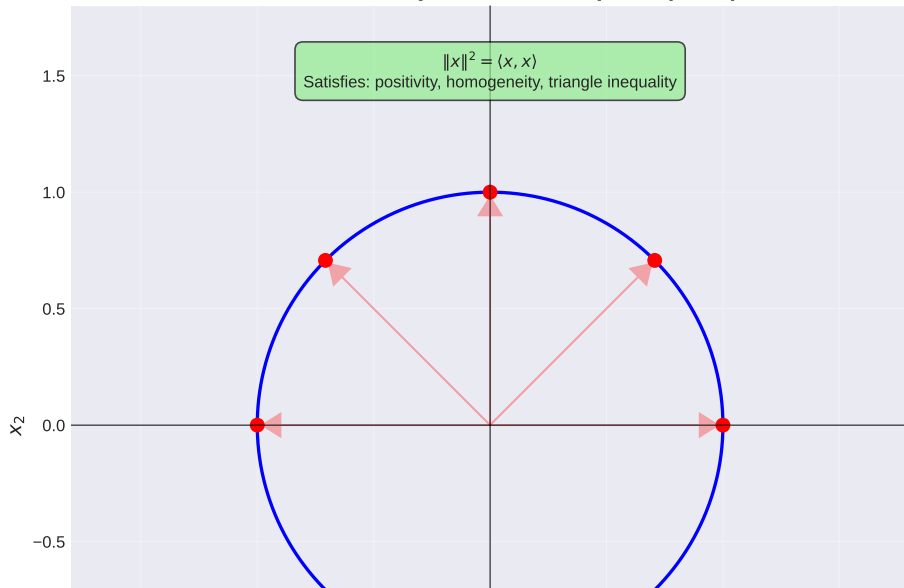
Convex optimization, projection methods

Approximation Theory

Best approximation, least squares

Induced Norm from Inner Product

Norm Induced by Inner Product (Unit Sphere)



Summary: Key Concepts

Inner Product Spaces:

- Definition via four properties (positivity, definiteness, conjugate symmetry, linearity)
- Cauchy-Schwarz inequality: $|\langle x, y \rangle| \leq \|x\| \|y\|$
- Parallelogram law characterizes inner product structure

Hilbert Spaces:

- Complete inner product spaces
- Self-dual (dual space isomorphic to itself via Riesz theorem)
- Examples: $\mathbb{R}^n$, ℓ^2 , $L^2[a, b]$

Orthogonal Structures:

- Orthonormal bases exist (Gram-Schmidt process)
- Fourier expansions via complete orthonormal systems
- Parseval's equality relates norms to coefficient sequences

Convergence:

- Strong convergence: $\|x_n - x\| \rightarrow 0$
- Weak convergence: $\langle x_n, y \rangle \rightarrow \langle x, y \rangle$ for all y
- Weak compactness of closed balls (Eberlein-Smulian)

References and Further Reading

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